

Hawaiian Coot – 12 Node Evolutionary Timeline System

This document outlines the interactive 12-node radial evolutionary timeline system for the Hawaiian Coot conservation website. Design Features: • Center animated Hawaiian Coot with glowing wetlands • 12 radial timeline nodes • Clicking a node opens TWO side panels • LEFT panel = “Why This Matters” • RIGHT panel = detailed information, maps, photos, audio, and conservation details • PREV and NEXT buttons navigate between nodes • No scrolling required • Cinematic Hawaiian wetland theme with glowing neon effects

01 — Ancient Rail Ancestors

~65 million years ago

Rail family emerges after dinosaur extinction.

Interactive Node Behavior:

- Opens LEFT and RIGHT detail panels
 - Includes PREV and NEXT buttons
 - Animated glowing node effects
 - Cinematic Hawaiian background atmosphere
 - Images, maps, sounds, and conservation facts appear dynamically
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02 — Wetland Adaptation

~30 million years ago

Rails adapt to marshes and shallow wetlands.

Interactive Node Behavior:

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03 — Pacific Expansion

~10 million years ago

Fulica genus spreads across continents.

Interactive Node Behavior:

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04 — Oceanic Dispersal

~1 million years ago

Ancestors begin long-distance Pacific dispersal.

Interactive Node Behavior:

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05 — Arrival in Hawai'i

~500,000 years ago

Early coots arrive in Hawaiian wetlands.

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06 — Island Isolation

~10,000 years ago

Isolation creates genetic divergence.

Interactive Node Behavior:

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07 — Fulica alai Emerges

Ancient Hawai'i

Hawaiian Coot becomes a distinct endemic species.

Interactive Node Behavior:

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08 — Native Wetland Ecosystem

Pre-human Hawai'i

Species thrives in native ecosystems.

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09 — Human Settlement Impact

1700s–1900s

Agriculture and development reduce wetlands.

Interactive Node Behavior:

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 - Cinematic Hawaiian background atmosphere
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10 — Near Extinction

1970s

Population numbers decline critically.

Interactive Node Behavior:

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11 — Conservation Efforts

1980s–Present

Wetland restoration and protection begin.

Interactive Node Behavior:

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12 — Hope for the Future

Today & Beyond

Education and conservation support recovery.

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Final Experience Goal

The timeline should feel like an interactive environmental documentary experience rather than a standard webpage. The radial design must match the cinematic homepage and glowing Hawaiian wetland theme.